

The core feedback across all reviewers was that the project looked polished but lacked a single convincing argument. The figures felt scattered rather than building toward a conclusion, and there was no clear throughline connecting them. In response, I restructured the entire project around one central claim: that obesity in America is fundamentally a poverty problem. Every figure now serves that argument explicitly, and the narrative moves deliberately from establishing the relationship, to showing it worsening over time, to showing it is geographic and not random.

The title was also flagged as a disconnect. My original title referenced zip codes while the visualizations focused on income, which are related but not the same thing. I replaced it with a title that captures both the geographic and economic dimensions the data actually supports, and rewrote the abstract and conclusion to match.

On the data side, my original dataset, the USDA Food Environment Atlas, covered too limited a time window to show trends over time. Making the argument that this gap is actively widening required longitudinal data, so I brought in a second dataset: the County Health Rankings from the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation, spanning 2010 to 2025. This was not a simple addition. It required building an entirely new data cleaning pipeline to handle 16 years of county-level records with inconsistent column naming, mixed data formats, and mismatched FIPS codes across years.

Formatting was addressed throughout as well. All four visualizations were rebuilt or restyled under a consistent dark theme, with all text standardized to white and font sizes increased significantly for poster readability. The figures were also reordered so that each one builds on the previous, moving from the income-obesity relationship, to trends over time by poverty level, to the multi-outcome gradient across diabetes and food insecurity, and finally to the geographic map as the visual conclusion that ties the argument together.

For the draft, the poster layout was built using Canva for the first time. While it was useful for getting something together quickly, it became clear that Canva's layout constraints made it difficult to give the visualizations the space they needed to be readable at poster scale. For the final version, the poster was rebuilt programmatically using Python, which gave full control over column widths, image sizing, and spacing, resulting in a much more polished and readable final product.